Unit 9 — Youth Protest Movements

Track E · Klasse 10 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can read a comparative text on two youth movements and identify their tactics, demands, and outcomes.*
- *I can use cleft-sentence emphasis (*it is precisely the demand that …*).*
- *I can hold a 5-minute panel-style discussion in formal English.*

Lead-in I

Maja's class compared two youth movements: a climate school-strike movement of the late 2010s and a housing-rights movement that began in Lisbon in 2024. Same age range, similar visibility online, very different policy outcomes. Mr. Yilmaz framed the question: *what made one of them legible to the system, and the other not?*

Reading I

Reading — *Two Youth Movements, Compared*

The school-strike climate movement of 2018-2020 drew millions of young people into weekly walk-outs across more than 130 countries. Its central demand — that governments listen to climate scientists — was clear, and its tactic — visible absence — was easily understood by the public. The Lisbon housing movement of 2024-2026, by contrast, used occupations of empty buildings and detailed policy papers. Its demands were narrower and harder to summarise. It is precisely the legibility of the first movement, some commentators argue, that made it useful to politicians; and precisely the specificity of the second that has produced sharper policy results.

Grammar — cleft-sentence emphasis

Reading II

It is/was X that/who … structure highlights one element.

- *It is precisely the legibility of the first movement that made it useful.*
- *It was the specificity that produced sharper results.*
- *What made the difference was the specificity.*

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Build a cleft sentence: emphasise *the legibility* in *the legibility of the first movement made it useful*.
2. T or F from text: school-strike was in 130+ countries; Lisbon housing demands were broad; specificity produced sharper results.

Niveau E — productive

3. Build 4 cleft sentences emphasising different elements of the same fact.

Your turn I

Panel-style discussion (5 min). Groups of 4. Each speaker delivers a 60-second opening on: *what makes a youth movement effective?* Use 1 cleft + 1 hedge + 1 specific example. Other speakers ask 1 follow-up.

Sample

What makes a youth movement effective is, I would argue, the legibility of its central demand. It is precisely when a movement can summarise itself in one sentence — listen to climate scientists — that the public can stand behind it without having to do homework. However, this comes at a cost. The Lisbon housing movement of 2024 was less legible; its demands were narrower and required several pages of explanation. And yet, the available evidence suggests, it was the

Your turn II

specificity of those demands that produced sharper policy results within two years. Both kinds of movement matter. The lesson, perhaps, is that legibility wins attention, while specificity wins the policy.

Reflect I

- I can identify tactics, demands, and outcomes of two youth movements.
- I can use cleft-sentence emphasis.
- I can hold a 5-minute panel-style discussion.

Further reading / listening I

- BBC News — youth-movement profiles.
- The Conversation — academic-leaning analysis.